

Madeline P. Ball

Department of Earth Sciences, University of Oregon
mpball@uoregon.edu · BallMP@si.edu · +1 (937) 594-8741 · [mpball60.github.io](https://github.com/mpball60)

Education

Ph.D. (in progress)	09/2024 – present	University of Oregon, Earth Sciences, advanced to candidacy 03/2026
B.S.	05/2021 – 12/2023	The Ohio State University, Evolution and Ecology, minor in Biology, with Research Distinction Thesis: “ <i>The ecology and evolution of bite force in geomorph rodents</i> ”
A.A.	01/2019 – 05/2021	The Ohio State University

Appointments & Research Experience

08/2026 – 08/2027	Predocctoral Fellow, Department of Paleobiology, Smithsonian Institution <i>Fellowship Advisors:</i> Dr. Stewart Edie, Dr. Kay Behrensmeyer
2026 – 2027	Courtesy Research Assistant (Type B), Department of Earth Sciences, University of Oregon
2025 – 2026	Research Assistant, Department of Earth Sciences, University of Oregon
2024 – 2026	Teaching Assistant, Department of Earth Sciences, University of Oregon
2020 – 2023	Undergraduate Researcher, Department of Evolution, Ecology, and Organismal Biology, The Ohio State University

Publications

Flores, D.F., **Ball, M.P.**, Famoso, N.A., & S.S.B Hopkins. *In review*. Additions to the Lonerock small mammal assemblage from the John Day Formation of Oregon, USA. *Journal of Paleontology*.

Honors & Awards

2026	Student Travel Grant, University of Oregon	\$1,000
2026	Teaching Excellence Award, University of Oregon	\$500
2026	Baldwin Scholarship, University of Oregon	\$2,000
2026	Smithsonian Institution Fellowship Program (SIFP)	\$50,000
2026	Burke Museum Collections Study Grant	\$2,000
2025	Student Travel Grant, Cordilleran Section, GSA	\$350
2025	Student Travel Grant, University of Oregon	\$1,000
2025	Condon Scholarship, University of Oregon	\$1,500
2024, 2025	Lokey Graduate Science Award, University of Oregon	Total: \$6,000
2024	PBDB Workshop Grant	\$1,000
2024	NAPC D&I and Student Travel Grant	\$500

2023	Margaret A. and Theodore A. Hendricks Travel Fund, The Ohio State University	\$2,000
2022, 2023	Dean's Undergraduate Research Scholarship, The Ohio State University	Total: \$1,000
2022	Undergraduate Research Apprentice Program, The Ohio State University	\$5,500
2022	Stone Laboratory Scholarship, The Ohio State University	\$550
2022	Andy Vick and Charles River Laboratory Award for Biology and Chemistry, The Ohio State University	\$1,000
2021, 2022	Conference Travel Award, The Ohio State University	Total: \$1,385
2021	Charlotte Mangum Student Support Program, Society for Integrative and Comparative Biology (SICB)	

Professional Development

2026	American Geophysical Union (AGU) Geosciences Congressional Visits Day (GEOCVD) – Paleontological Society Representative, Washington, DC
2024	North American Rodents: Landscapes, Ecology, and Evolution (NARLEE) Field Trip
2024	Paleobiology Database Summer Workshop, George Mason University, Fairfax, VA
2024	North American Rodents: Landscapes, Ecology, and Evolution (NARLEE) Workshop, Mammalian diversification and distribution dynamics on evolving landscapes

Presentations & Abstracts

** Indicates undergraduate mentee*

Ball, M.P., Hopkins, S.S.B., Cham, M.R., & C.A.E. Strömberg. The small mammal fauna of Beatys Butte (Harney County, Oregon, U.S.A.). Annual Meeting of the Society of Vertebrate Paleontology (2026), Cleveland, OH. [Poster]

Schweikhard, S.*****, Hopkins, S.S.B., & **M.P. Ball**. Miocene mammalian community structure evolution in response to vegetation change in Nebraska. Undergraduate Research Symposium (2026), University of Oregon, Eugene, OR. [Poster]

Sucec, K.*****, Hopkins, S.S.B., & **M.P. Ball**. Phylogenetic Signal in the Order Carnivora. Undergraduate Research Symposium (2026), University of Oregon, Eugene, OR. [Poster]

Quintanilla, A.L., **Ball, M.P.**, & S.S.B. Hopkins. Phylogeny and ontogeny of a middle Miocene kentriodontid (Cetacea: Odontoceti) from Oregon. Society for Integrative and Comparative Biology Annual Meeting (2026), Portland, OR. [Poster]

Ball, M.P. & S.S.B. Hopkins. Reassessing Rodent Diversity in the Oligo-Miocene of the Pacific Northwest Using Museum Dark Data. GSA Connects (2025), San Antonio, TX. [Poster]

Ball, M.P., Poorboy, D.M., & J.J.M. Caledo. Exploring the evolution and ecology of geomorph rodents using bite force analysis and GIS. North American Paleontological Convention (2024), Ann Arbor, MI. [Poster]

Ball, M.P., Poorboy, D.M., & J.J.M. Caledo. A Deep Time Perspective on Bite Force: A Case Study in Geomorph Rodents. Annual Meeting of the Society of Vertebrate Paleontology (2023), Cincinnati, OH. [Poster]

Hunt, M.E., **Ball, M.P.**, Claxton, A., Martin, R.A., Jimenez-Hidalgo, E., & J.J.M. Caledo. Contrasting body size evolution in entoptychine and geomyine gophers (Rodentia, Geomyidae). Annual Meeting of the Society of Vertebrate Paleontology (2023), Cincinnati, OH. [Poster]

Ball, M.P., Poorboy, D.M., Socki, F., & J.J.M. Caledo. The ecology and evolution of bite force in geomorph rodents. Great Lakes Student PaleoConference (2022), Chicago, IL. [Poster]

Ball, M.P., Poorboy, D.M., Socki, F., & J.J.M. Caledo. 2021. Bite force estimates in geomyoid rodents: ecological and evolutionary implications. Society for Comparative and Integrative Biology Annual Meeting (2022), Phoenix, AZ. [Poster]

Teaching Experience

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| 2026 | Graduate Teaching Fellow, EARTH 410/304: The Fossil Record, University of Oregon |
| 2026 | Graduate Teaching Fellow, EARTH 436/536: Paleoecology and Functional Morphology, University of Oregon |
| 2025 | Graduate Teaching Fellow, EARTH 203: History of Life, University of Oregon |
| 2024 | Graduate Teaching Fellow, EARTH 101: Exploring Planet Earth, University of Oregon |
| 2023 | Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, BIO 1114: Form, Function, Diversity, and Ecology, The Ohio State University |

Field Experience

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| 2026 | John Day & Eastern, OR, USA
Participated in paleontological fieldwork in the Arikareean deposits of the John Day Formation, Barstovian deposits of the Butte Creek Volcanic Sandstone and Mascall Formations, Clarendonian deposits of the Juntura and Ironside Formations, and the Hemphillian deposits of the Rattlesnake Formation. |
| 2025 | John Day & Eastern, OR, USA
Participated in paleontological fieldwork in Arikareean deposits of the John Day Basin, Barstovian deposits of the Succor Creek Formation, and Hemingfordian deposits of Cogan Buttes, and led fieldwork in Barstovian deposits near Beatys Butte. |
| 2025 | Porrentruy, Switzerland, JURASSICA Museum
Excavated actinopterygian, crocodylomorph, and testudinate fossils from the Kimmeridgian-aged deposits of the Reuchenette Fm. |

Professional Memberships

2025 - present Geological Society of America
2025 - present Society of Vertebrate Paleontology
2024 - present Paleontological Society

Advisors

Dissertation committee

Dr. Samantha Hopkins (Advisor/Chair), Department of Earth Sciences, University of Oregon
Dr. Nicholas Famoso, Department of Earth Sciences, University of Oregon; John Day Fossil Beds NM, OR
Dr. Susheel Adusumilli, Department of Earth Sciences, University of Oregon
Dr. Stephen Frost, Department of Anthropology, University of Oregon

Undergraduate

Dr. Jonathan Caledo (Advisor/Chair), Department of Evolution, Ecology, and Organismal Biology, The Ohio State University
Dr. Andreas Chavez, Department of Evolution, Ecology, and Organismal Biology, The Ohio State University
